{ Issue 03 }
OCT 2026

Reimagining the City...

Legend

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Luxury and Homes
Devi Sahani



DEVELOPERS DIARY
Seema Singh

COVER STORY
"The Steady Hand of Maharashtra"

exclusive Interview
Manisha Patankar Mhaiskar,IAS



LEGENDS

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CONTENT

10
MHADA's Bigger Picture
IAS SANJEEV JAISWAL

16
WHERE FIRE MEETS FABRIC
Gautam Singhania

THE DESIGN OF INHERITANCE
SARAH SHAM

22
Face of Courage
Vishwas Nagre Patil

26
DRIVING RELEVANCE AT SCALE
-GAYATRI V.YADAV

31
34
From Harvard to Home: MP Shrikant Shinde's Inspiring US Trip for Inclusive Growth

39
VIKAS OBEROI
WHERE LUXURY MEETS LEGACY

44
THE FUTURE OF BANKING IS DIGITAL
-JAY KOTAK

49
SAREE,BOOTS & POINT TO PROVE
-KANGANA RANAUT

52
A COURT OF HIS OWN
-VIJAY SULE

55
THE ECOFEMINIST REWRITING
-SHREYA GHODAWAT

60
THE REWRITE
-TANMAY BHAT

64
THE ARCHITECT OF INSTITUTION
-VIRAANSH BHANUSHALI

68
ONE DROP AT A TIME
-CREP DOG CREW

THE LONG CONVERSATION
-RAJ SHAMANI

72
76
THE MALKIN
-PARUL GULATI

80
EKUAL BY
-KSHIRAJA SURENDRANATH

84
THE SECOND FOUNDER
-SHASHVAT GOENKA

88
PLAY STAY REPEAT
-COURT SIDE

92
THE NOOK
-HOME BUT BETTER

96
When Monsoon Meets Izakaya
-GIGI

EDITORIAL

What happens when the people rebuilding Mumbai's housing, banking, and skyline are all moving at once and in the same direction.



Legend is, in its second edition, still a young magazine. But the stories we are pursuing are not young. They are decades in the making. We are simply arriving at the moment when they are ready to be told.

There is a particular quality to the present moment in Mumbai that resists easy description. It is not optimism, exactly optimism implies uncertainty about the outcome. What one encounters instead is a kind of coordinated motion: institutions and individuals acting in parallel, each within their own mandate, yet producing something that feels, from the outside, like deliberate choreography.

The cover story of this edition sits at the heart of that motion. Shri Sanjeev Jaiswal, IAS, Vice President and CEO of MHADA, is not a man who talks about transformation in the abstract. He produces it in measurable units homes constructed, buildings redeveloped, grievances resolved within a hundred days. The scale of his current mandate, eight lakh homes across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region by 2030, is the kind of number that sounds like a press release until you visit the clusters he is redesigning. Then it becomes architectural reality.

What connects the stories in this edition is not sector or scale. It is a shared orientation toward the future: a refusal to be governed by what the past assumed was impossible. Whether the subject is affordable housing, digital banking, luxury real estate, or a padel court in Worli, the underlying question is the same what does this city deserve, and who is building it.

Legend is, in its second edition, still a young magazine. But the stories we are pursuing are not young. They are decades in the making. We are simply arriving at the moment when they are ready to be told.

India's most consequential stories are rarely the loudest ones. They compound quietly, in offices without press releases and decisions without fanfare. Our job is to find them before history does. We are still learning how to do that well. But we are learning fast.

"The city does not pause to explain itself. Nor should the journalism that covers it."

— Editor's Note, October 2026

PUBLIC SERVICE

Three Decades in the Service of Maharashtra A Career Built on Discipline, Crisis Management and Institutional Trust

"A steady hand with deep institutional knowledge built one posting, one crisis, one decision at atime."

— How Ms. Mhaiskar is described within Maharashtra's bureaucratic circles

Manisha Patankar Mhaiskar was born on 16 March 1969 into a Maharashtrian family that placed a premium on education and public service. Her upbringing was shaped by parental encouragement toward a career in the civil services, set against a home environment that valued discipline and consistent learning. That early grounding proved formative: in 1992, she joined the Indian Administrative Service in the Maharashtra cadre, beginning a career that would span more than three decades and touch nearly every major arm of state administration.She holds a degree in law (LL.B.) and is proficient in both English and Marathi — a combination that has served her well across postings that required equal comfort in policy drafting and public-facing administratiN. Few officers can claim a career as wide-ranging as Ms. Mhaiskar's. Over more than thirty years and roughly two dozen postings across eleven locations, she has held charge as Assistant Collector, Deputy Commissioner, District Collector, Municipal Commissioner, Additional Municipal Commissioner, Chief Executive Officer, Secretary, Principal Secretary, Director General, and, eventually, Additional Chief Secretary.

Her portfolios have included Environment and Climate Change, Protocol, Public Works, Urban Development, Municipal Administration and Medical Education — a breadth that reflects both versatility and the confidence repeatedly placed in her by the state government.





It was during the COVID-19 pandemic that Ms. Mhaiskar's administrative reputation was most sharply defined. Handling complex operational challenges through one of the state's most difficult public-health periods, she earned recognition as a dependable crisis manager.

Colleagues and observers within the administration have pointed to her decisiveness and operational clarity in the municipal and health portfolios she oversaw during this period as among the more demanding tests of her career and ones she met with characteristic composure.

In a significant reshuffle announced by the Maharashtra government, Ms. Mhaiskar was appointed Additional Chief Secretary (Home), succeeding Iqbal Singh Chahal, effective 31 January 2026. She formally took charge on 2 February 2026, having previously served as Additional Chief Secretary, Public Works Department.

The Home Department is among the most sensitive assignments in the state secretariat, encompassing police administration, internal security, disaster response and coordination with central security agencies — a portfolio the government entrusted to her on the strength of three decades of demonstrated administrative judgment.

Ms. Mhaiskar is married to Milind Mhaiskar, himself a 1992-batch IAS officer of the Maharashtra cadre, currently serving as Additional Chief Secretary, Public Works Department. Within bureaucratic circles, the couple is regarded as a rare instance of two senior officers of the same batch simultaneously holding key portfolios — a dynamic that reflects the institutional depth both bring to Maharashtra's administration.

With 34 years of service, 21 documented postings and a portfolio that now includes one of the state's most consequential departments, Manisha Patankar Mhaiskar's career reads as a case study in institutional endurance — the product of steady advancement, sound judgment under pressure, and an evident commitment to the discipline instilled in her from an early age. .

LEGEND

A Career Across Every Layer of Governance

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How Ms. Mhaiskar is described within Maharashtra's bureaucratic circles



LEGEND



The IAS is an institution that demands versatility an officer may find herself managing disaster relief one year and negotiating land acquisition for a highway the next. She embraced every assignment with characteristic rigour. Over three decades, she served across a range of critical portfolios, steadily ascending through Maharashtra's administrative hierarchy. She served as Additional Chief Secretary and Chief Protocol Officer in the General Administration Department before being transferred and posted as Additional Chief Secretary, Public Works Department (PWD), holding additional charge of Chief Protocol Officer. Her tenure at the PWD one of Maharashtra's most operationally intensive departments, responsible for roads, bridges, and public buildings was particularly notable. Under her stewardship, the PWD was honoured by the Chief Minister for outstanding performance in the State Government's 150-day e-Governance reform programme. The award, received by Patankar-Mhaiskar herself, was a recognition not just of her department's efficiency,

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Pillars of

ADMINISTRATION

Over three decades of tireless public service, from district roads to the corridors of the Home Department.

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Her appointment has been widely viewed as a recognition of her consistent track record in high-stakes roles. Industry observers and governance watchers alike note that her elevation to ACS (Home) may well be a precursor to even higher responsibility. In a world that often asks women to prove themselves twice over, She has spent thirty-three years simply doing the work with quiet confidence, institutional depth, and an abiding commitment to public service. As Additional Chief Secretary (Home), Manisha Patankar-Mhaiskar steps into one of the most scrutinised offices in Maharashtra's bureaucracy. The challenges ahead are significant managing a complex law-and-order apparatus, modernising policing through technology, and ensuring that governance reaches the last mile. But if her record in the PWD, the General Administration Department, and across decades of field postings is any guide, she is more than equal to the task What distinguishes Manisha Patankar-Mhaiskar from many of her peers is not just the breadth of her portfolio — it is her inner architecture. She subscribes to the philosophy of "living in the moment." For her, life is "now" — and that is the reason she is at peace with herself daughter rather than find her a match — is, she believes, not exceptional. It is what every family is capable of, if it chooses differently. To young women aspiring to join the civil services, her message is both grounding and galvanising: The opportunities are many. Women should exercise the freedom of choice. I look to each new day that brings new challenges. Do your best and thank the Almighty for a day well spent.



LEGEND

Steel in Service: How Manisha Patankar Mhaiskar Shaped Maharashtra's Governance



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The Indian Administrative Service is not known for love stories. It is known for transfers, postings, difficult districts, and thankless tasks. And yet, within the storied 1992 batch of the Maharashtra cadre, something quietly extraordinary began — a partnership between two young civil servants that would, over three decades, become one of the most admired in Maharashtra's bureaucratic history.

Milind Mhaiskar is a 1991 batch IAS officer and an IIT Bombay alumnus. Manisha Patankar entered the IAS through the 1992 batch of the Maharashtra cadre. Their careers began almost in parallel, navigating the vast machinery of the Maharashtra government — field postings, district administration, state-level roles — each carving an independent identity while remaining each other's steadiest anchor. The bonding between Manisha and Milind is not only that of an ideal couple but also of being good compatriots — having started their careers almost in parallel, the friendship only strengthened over time. The Indian Administrative Service is not known for love stories. It is known for transfers, postings, difficult districts, and thankless tasks. And yet, within the storied 1992 batch of the Maharashtra cadre, something quietly extraordinary began — a partnership between two young civil servants that would, over three decades, become one of the most admired in Maharashtra's bureaucratic history.

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Partners in Service
Manisha & Milind Mhaiskar Maharashtra's Most Remarkable IAS Couple



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30+
Years of Service

8 Lakh +
Homes Target in MMR

38,000 +
Jai Jeevan Mission Projects Revived

13,000 +
Cessed Buildings Earmkred For Redevelopment

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The Mother of a Thousand Causes

How Seema Singh turned a mother's love into a movement that has touched over ten lakh lives across India

There is a particular kind of resolve that only shows itself when someone chooses a harder path over an easier one. Seema Singh had the easier path available to her. Married into a family with deep roots in India's pharmaceutical industry her father-in-law chairs Alkem Pharma, and her husband, M.K. Singh, serves as its director and as Managing Director of Indchemie Health Specialties Pvt. Ltd. — she could have lived a life defined entirely by comfort. Instead, in the year 2000, she chose to build something else: an organisation that would eventually reach more than ten lakh people across fifteen-plus states.



In a philanthropic landscape crowded with short-lived initiatives and photo-op charity, MeghaShrey's twenty-five-year run is itself a kind of statement. Most grassroots efforts struggle to survive their founder's initial burst of enthusiasm; fewer still manage to grow their footprint, year after year, without losing sight of the people they set out to serve. Seema Singh's story is a study in exactly that kind of persistence the unglamorous, decades-long kind that rarely gets written about until the numbers become too large to ignore.

Seema Singh's story begins far from the high-rises of Mumbai. Born and raised in Patna, Bihar, she completed her education at Patna University before moving to Mumbai to build a new chapter of her life

For an organisation without the budget of a pharmaceutical major or the reach of a government health ministry, moving a health conversation into the mainstream is no small feat. It happened because Seema Singh built relationships — with survivors, with doctors, with celebrities willing to lend their platforms, and with policymakers willing to listen..

MEGHA श्रेय



Today she lives in Worli, a mother to two children Dr. Meghna and Shrey Shree Anant Singh — and it is in their names, quite literally, that her life's work is signed. MeghaShrey, the NGO she founded in 2000, is a portmanteau of her children's names, a small but telling detail: for Seema Singh, family and philanthropy were never separate ideas. They grew from the same root.

What started as a personal calling has, over two decades, become one of India's more recognisable grassroots philanthropic efforts — one built quietly, campaign by campaign, community by community, long before hashtags and headlines caught up with it.

f there is one initiative that has come to define Seema Singh's public work, it is the Cervical Cancer Free India campaign — an effort aimed at awareness, screening access, and vaccination advocacy against a disease that remains one of the leading causes of cancer deaths among Indian women, despite being largely preventable.

"Working for the upliftment of the underprivileged sections of society was initiated as a dream which, over the years, has become my life's mission." — Seema Singh

"Working for the upliftment of the underprivileged sections of society was initiated as a dream which, over the years, has become my life's mission." — Seema Singh



A Campaign That Became a Movement: Cervical Cancer Free India

The campaign found high-profile support along the way. Actor Shruti Haasan lent her voice to the cause, helping push the conversation about cervical cancer out of clinical brochures and into mainstream visibility. The Union Minister for Road Transport and Highways, Nitin Gadkari, publicly honoured Seema Singh's contribution to the initiative — recognition that placed a grassroots health awareness campaign squarely on the national radar.

For an organisation without the budget of a pharmaceutical major or the reach of a government health ministry, moving a health conversation into the mainstream is no small feat. It happened because Seema Singh built relationships — with survivors, with doctors, with celebrities willing to lend their platforms, and with policymakers willing to listen.

Cervical cancer awareness may be MeghaShrey's most visible campaign, but it sits alongside a much wider body of work. The organisation's stated focus areas include education for children, women's empowerment, food security, and rural development the unglamorous, unrelenting categories of work that rarely make it to a press release but define whether an NGO is doing real work or simply good marketing One recurring initiative an annual umbrella distribution drive for children, teachers, and farmers ahead of the monsoon captures this ethos well. It is not a campaign built for virality.

It is a campaign built for people who will otherwise walk to school or to their fields soaked through, year after year, until someone decides that shouldn't have to be normal.



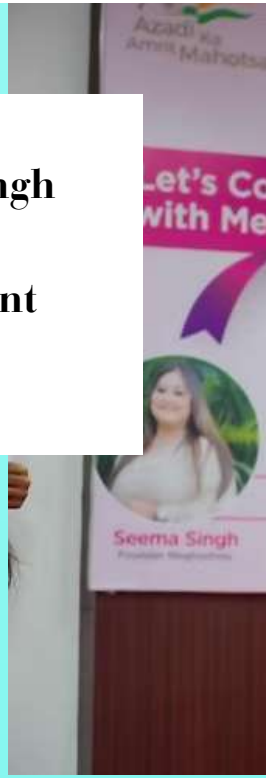
Seema Singh being felicitated by Union Minister Nitin Gadkari for her contribution to the Cervical Cancer Free India campaign

By its own account, MeghaShrey has now run over 100 projects, reached more than fifteen states, delivered five-plus nationwide campaigns, and touched the lives of over ten lakh people. Numbers like these are easy to print and much harder to earn — they represent thousands of individual decisions, made over more than twenty years, to keep showing up. What distinguishes this body of work from a purely event-driven charity model is its emphasis on continuity. A one-time distribution drive photographs well; a programme that returns to the same schools and the same villages year after year builds something closer to trust. That distinction matters most in the sectors MeghaShrey has chosen — women's empowerment and children's education are not problems that respond to a single intervention. They require the kind of patient, repeated presence that doesn't always make for compelling social media content, but which is precisely what moves outcomes over a generation rather than a news cycle.



Twenty-Five Years, Ten Lakh Lives
The Quiet Revolution of Seema Singh

From a Mother's Love to a Movement
Inside Seema Singh's 25-Year War Silence



Seema Singh's work has not gone unnoticed at the highest levels of Indian public life. She has met with President of India Droupadi Murmu to discuss initiatives for social welfare and the impact of MeghaShrey's work. Former President Ram Nath Kovind honoured her as a "Champion of Change" for the Cervical Cancer Free India campaign. She has also been recognised by BJP Mumbai President Ashish Shelar, Union Minister Anurag Thakur, and has featured as Chief Guest at the Times 40 Under 40 in 2023, besides receiving the Times Power Women Award, presented by veteran actor Anupam Kher.

These are not small rooms to be invited into. But what stands out, speaking to those familiar with her work, is that the recognition has followed the work — not preceded it. MeghaShrey ran its programmes in classrooms and clinics long before Rashtrapati Bhavan took notice.

In August 2025, Seema Singh took her philanthropic vision a step further — not by receiving an honour, but by creating one. She organised the Sarvottam Nagrik Samman 2025, held at Hotel Sahara Star in Mumbai, under the presence of the Governor of Maharashtra, who opened proceedings with a keynote address underlining the significance of civic duty in nation-building.

The evening brought together an extraordinary cross-section of Indian public life: Padma Vibhushan Dr. Anil Kakodkar, the nuclear scientist; Padma Bhushan Dr. Vijay Bhatkar, architect of India's first indigenous supercomputer; Padma Shri Dr. Shankar Mahadevan, the celebrated composer and vocalist; filmmaker Imtiaz Ali; Padma Bhushan Anupam Kher; and Olympic boxer Padma Shri Vijender Singh, among other honourees.

But the evening's real intent was articulated by Seema Singh herself, in a line that captures the philosophy behind two decades of her work:



She Didn't Wait for Permission
How One Woman Built India's Silent Health Movement

It is a fitting summary of what MeghaShrey has always tried to do: shine a light not on the loudest voices, but on the ones doing the work in silence — teachers in under-resourced schools, health workers in rural clinics, women running self-help groups without any expectation of applause. Twenty-five years after MeghaShrey's founding, Seema Singh's story resists a tidy conclusion — largely because it isn't finished. Each year brings a new campaign, a new state reached,

a new set of "silent warriors" pulled, briefly, into the light. What began as a tribute to her two children has become something considerably larger than any one family: a standing reminder that sustained, unglamorous, decades-long commitment can still move the needle on India's hardest social challenges. If the last two decades are any indication, that pledge is less an ambition than a habit — one she shows no sign of breaking.

PLAYER ONE

Simple, Speed, Stability

From Wankhede to 600 million gamers the minister betting on people who can't vote yet.

Respected Minister Ashish Shelar has spent three decades in politics and sports administration. His portfolios now run from artificial intelligence to Maratha forts and, as of last week, a national esports federation. What connects them is a single constituency he cannot win by canvassing.



THE OTHER HALF OF THE DESK

The room in New Delhi on the evening of 28 August was not a stadium, and nobody was playing anything. Board members and state representatives of the Esports Games Federation put a proposal, seconded it, and elected Ashish Shelar their president without a dissenting vote. Within weeks, an Indian esports contingent leaves for the Asian Games in Japan. Somewhere in that sequence sits the shape of a political career that has quietly become a wager on people under thirty.

The number Shelar reached for on accepting was six hundred million his estimate of Indians now engaged with gaming in some form. In most political speech, a figure of that size is decoration. In his case it keeps turning up. The same demographic sits underneath almost every file that crosses his desk in Mantralaya. Born in Sindhudurg in October 1972 and raised in Mumbai, Shelar took a science degree before a law one, and entered public life through the party's student and youth wings rather than through inheritance. He was a corporator, then a member of the Legislative Council in 2012, and in 2014 he took Bandra West from the Congress veteran Baba Siddique by a margin of close to twenty-seven thousand votes. He has held the seat since, and led the Mumbai unit of his party across three separate terms an unusually long organisational run in a city that rarely rewards patience.

The parallel career was in sport. He was elected a vice-president of the Mumbai Cricket Association in 2015 and its president in 2017, and became treasurer of the Board of Control for Cricket in India in October 2022. He gave that post up when he was sworn in as a cabinet minister in December 2024, the Supreme Court's Lodha-era rules being clear that ministers do not run the world's wealthiest cricket board. He remains on the Asian Cricket Council board. In April 2026, the Maharashtra cabinet carved out an independent Department of Electronics, Information Technology and Artificial Intelligence, converting the old IT directorate into a commissionerate. It is the kind of decision that never makes a front page and generally determines whether a policy has an owner. Shelar is the minister it reports to. Nine days later, the same cabinet approved the Maharashtra AI Policy 2026. The headline figures are large ten thousand crore rupees of anticipated investment, one and a half lakh jobs by 2031, six centres of excellence, five AI innovation cities, two thousand GPUs offered as shared compute, a five-hundred-crore venture fund, support for five thousand MSMEs. The number Shelar himself led with was smaller and more specific: two lakh young people trained in AI skills. Alongside it runs the state's plan for India's first dedicated AI university, guided by a task force that seats IIT Bombay and IIM Mumbai next to Google India, Mahindra and L&T.







Esports is developing rapidly in India, and our youth possess immense talent."

- ADV Ashish Shelar

Minister of Cultural Affairs of Maharashtra

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The Data Coast

Simple, Speed, Stability

The minister who walked 3,000 kilometres to reach a room full of global CEOs.



BUILDING VIZAG'S SILICON COAST

In 2019, Nara Lokesh lost Mangalagiri by just over five thousand votes. It was the kind of defeat that ends careers the son of a four-term chief minister, unable to win a single assembly seat. The trolling was relentless. The verdict, in most rooms, was that he had inherited a name but not the instinct.

Five years later, he won the same seat by more than ninety thousand votes.

What happened in between was a padayatra. Over 2023 and 2024, Lokesh walked more than three thousand kilometres across Andhra Pradesh under the banner of Yuva Galam a youth-focused march that put him in villages, on foot, in conversation, for over a year. It was not a campaign strategy so much as a corrective. The politician who had been accused of being distant returned having covered the state at walking pace. He took charge as Minister for Human Resource Development and for Information Technology, Electronics and Communications on 12 June 2024, adding Real Time Governance to the portfolio a combination that hands him both the state's classrooms and its server farms. In April 2026, he was named National Working President of the Telugu Desam Party. The clearest expression of his second term is a coastal city of two million people better known for its cricket stadium than its bandwidth.

Visakhapatnam is being rebranded as "AI City Vizag", anchored by a Google hyperscale data centre campus spread across Adavivaram, Tarluvada and Rambilli, with operations targeted from mid-2028. A joint venture between Reliance Industries, Brookfield and Digital Realty is developing a further AI data centre in the same city. The state has met its 6.5GW data-centre target, with three cable landing stations planned for Visakhapatnam positioning the port as a landing point for submarine cables running towards Singapore. The scale invites scepticism, and Lokesh has met it directly rather than deflecting. When environmental groups raised concerns about water demand, he clarified in the council that data centres would draw from the industrial allocation of Polavaram water, not from the city's residential supply. He has also pointed to a 100-mld desalination plant, dedicated power arrangements, and a tariff reduction rather than an increase. His pitch to investors is procedural rather than promotional. He describes it as three S's simple, speed, stability and argues that governments should behave as long-term partners to industry. On the Google project, his framing is characteristically economic: the point is less the direct jobs than the ripple effect. It would be easy to file Lokesh as an IT minister. The education brief is the harder, slower, less photogenic half of his job and arguably the one that will define him.





Once you invest in Andhra, it is no longer your project. It is ours

- Nara Lokesh

Minister for Human Resources Development of Andhra Pradesh

He has pushed through transparent teacher transfers, moved to fill long-standing vacancies through Mega DSC, introduced school ratings, and set a stated goal of lifting Andhra Pradesh's literacy position. None of it generates a headline in the way a fifteen-billion-dollar announcement does. All of it determines whether the state has the workforce to occupy the buildings he is busy attracting.

That is the coherence of the portfolio, and it may be deliberate. A data city without engineers is a real estate project. Fortune India's August 2026 issue called him "Andhra's Rising Star" a description that is either premature or overdue, depending on the room. Lokesh cites investment agreements worth $175 billion across 760 projects, and claims the state received close to a quarter of all foreign direct investment into India in 2025.





The commitments are signed. The concrete, mostly, is not yet poured. Data centres announced in 2026 will be judged in 2030, and the education reforms on an even longer horizon. What has already changed is the man making the case. The politician who could not hold Mangalagiri is now the one global technology firms fly into Vizag to meet. Whether Andhra Pradesh becomes India's AI coast is a question for the decade. Whether Nara Lokesh earned his second innings is not.

The Man Who Traded the Pit for the Pocket

Dinesh Thakkar, Angel One, and thirty years of teaching India to invest

Before the app, the pit. In 1996, stock broking meant a crowded floor where brokers shouted and signalled in hand gestures to buy and sell shares. Angel One made its debut that year and pioneered the use of walkie-talkies so investors could learn which trades had been executed for them. It was a small idea for its time, but it showed what the firm would keep doing: find the gap between a customer and the market, then close it with technology.

The man behind it is Dinesh Thakkar. He was born in Mulund, Mumbai, into a business family in textile trading, and he studied science at Kishinchand Chellaram College. The rest of his story is a lesson in learning by doing. By his own account, three investors backed his business with ₹50 lakh each, and Angel One was incorporated in 1996. He was reading about computers as early as the mid-1980s, when India was just getting ready for them. He spotted the wave early. Angel One's history divides into three chapters. First came the floor, with shouting, signals and relationships. Then came the screen, when trading moved online and access widened. Now comes the phone, where a first-time investor from a small town can open an account in minutes. The company is headquartered in Andheri (East), Mumbai, and is listed on both the BSE and NSE. Its reach, across a country that is only beginning to invest in equities, is the real measure of that shift

Today Thakkar is looking further ahead. Angel One believes AI can personalise an individual's financial journey, though Thakkar says the real test is whether it delivers tangible value to users. That caution is worth noting. In a season when every fintech promises an "AI-first" future, the founder is measuring the technology by whether it helps the customer. He has also brought in fresh leadership for the next phase. Ambarish Kenghe joined as Group CEO in March 2025, while Thakkar stays on as Chairman and Managing Director. Outside the boardroom, Thakkar's public bio describes him as a super-car enthusiast, which suits a man who has spent his career working at speed. His larger ambition is stated just as plainly: to make Angel One the largest retail broking house in the country. The pit has gone quiet. The person who once signalled a trade across a crowded floor now taps a screen, and in a small way Dinesh Thakkar helped make that possible. Today the company is headquartered in Andheri (East), Mumbai, and is listed on both the BSE and the NSE. Its filings put the workforce at 3,823 employees as of 31 March 2025. It competes in a crowded field. Platforms such as Groww are counted among its top rivals. Staying relevant in a market like that takes constant reinvention.





LEGEND

A textile family, a different ambition

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The number is 1996. That was the year Angel One Ltd was incorporated, and the year the firm's early experiments began, including walkie-talkies that let investors know which trades had been executed on their behalf.

3 Eras, 1 Founder

In that era the market's centre of gravity was the trading pit, where brokers yelled and used complex hand signals to buy and sell shares. Three decades later, the company that grew out of it is a listed financial services group. It is headquartered in Andheri (East), Mumbai, and trades on both the BSE and NSE. Those figures come from the company's published profile. A firm that began with shouting and walkie-talkies now runs on the scale of a technology platform.



Growth stories are easy to tell and harder to prove. The Numbers Behind the Journey.

- **₹4,272 crore revenue**
- **₹1,126 crore in net income**
- **3,823 employees**

Every long-lived company has a moment when it must choose between defending its old business and building a new one. Angel One's came when discount brokerage rewrote the rules. One leadership profile describes how Thakkar pivot the firm from a traditional broking setup into a technology-first digita platform, moving to a high-volume, low-cost model.

It was not a comfortable decision, since it meant reshaping a business that was already working. But the pivot i the reason a firm founded in th era of hand signals is still releva in the era of smartphones.



The building, a seven-storey tower with a RERA carpet area of 63,000 sq ft, is at Embassy Terrazza. He has said the location, sea views and privacy were the key considerations in his search for a new home.
It is a fitting image for a man who started in a business family in Mulund and now looks out at the Arabian Sea. For a magazine spread, it also gives the story a strong visual close.
Thakkar's attention now is on AI. He has said that AI can personalise an individual's financial journey, but that the real test is whether it delivers tangible value to users. That is a founder's caution, and it matches how Angel One has treated technology from the start, whether walkie-talkies or algorithms.

Next Level

Thakkar's own beginnings were modest. He was bornin Mulund,Mumbai, into a business family involved in textile trading, and studied science at Kishinchand Chellaram College. His path into markets was not a conventional one. Media profiles describe him as a 12th-pass founder of a multi-billion-dollar company, a label that says more about his self-made route than about any lack of ambition. He also formalised the company's growth with outside capital. The company has raised $38.4M in funding from IFC, a marker of institutional confidence in a business that began with a handful of private backers. Every founder story has a chapter about arrival, and Thakkar's made headlines. He agreed to buy a luxury residential tower on Juhu Tara Road, Mumbai, for approximately ₹711 crore.

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Turning Poetry and Purpose into Climate Action

Many young people talk about changing the world. Mumbai-based Rajlakshmi Patil has been doing something about it since her teens, through poetry, community service and climate research. Rajlakshmi spent her school years in the Swiss Alps, where the mountains and valleys deepened her love for nature. She began writing poems at 13, and at 18 she published her first collection, Mystic. The poems draw on her time in the Alps and her life in Mumbai, and reflect the people who shaped her, especially her grandfather, Dr. D. Y. Patil.



In 2018 she founded the Charity Soccer League, which raises funds to improve medical facilities for paediatric patients. In 2019 she organised a mangrove cleanliness drive, and she has taken part in regular beach clean-ups and tree plantations in Mumbai. Her other interests include skiing, guitar, piano and football

NGOs and think tanks to research and propose practical sustainability solutions. It also publishes a blog on topics such as the social drivers of climate change and rights-based approaches to climate action.



LEGEND

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The poems draw on her time in the Alps and her life in Mumbai, and reflect the people who shaped her, especially her grandfather, Dr. D. Y. Patil. The book was also an act of giving. All proceeds from its sale were donated to D-CAL, an organisation working for environmental conservation. Her activism has been hands on.



Rajlakshmi went on to study Geography at University College London, and she has celebrated completing her BSc there. Alongside her studies she founded the D.Y. Patil Climate Action Lab (D-CAL). D-CAL is a policy action lab that partners with academic institutions,



Aaim is to connect academic research with real community engagement and to empower students and local communities to lead grassroots environmental initiatives Her guiding principle is "service before self," and she sees helping others as the surest route to finding oneself. She argues that nature does not need to change; people's attitudes and behaviour towards it do

LEGEND

A philosophy of service

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Many young people speak about changing the world. Rajlakshmi Patil, from Mumbai, has spent her teenage and early adult years doing something about it. Through poetry, charity work and climate research, she has shown that a young voice can carry real weight when it is backed by consistent action.

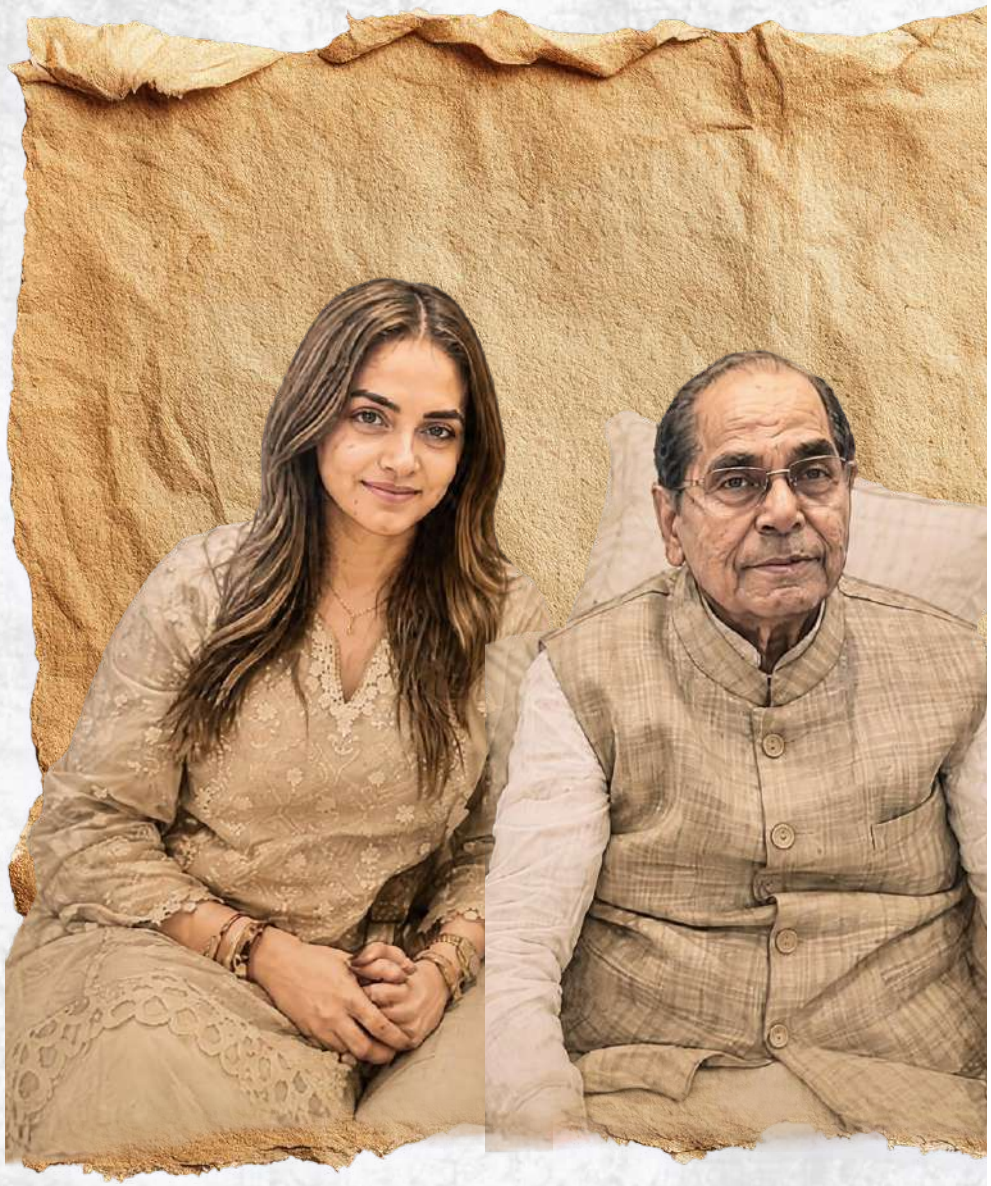
Alongside her studies, she founded the D.Y. Patil Climate Action Lab, known as D-CAL. It is a policy action lab that combines environmental and climate policy solutions with sustainability research, partnering with academic institutions, NGOs and think tanks. She formed a board of prominent figures in environmental research and conservation, who review interdisciplinary research reports and community-inclusive action proposals. D-CAL also has a public voice. Its blog has published articles on subjects such as the social drivers of climate change, rights-based approaches to climate action, and the social impacts of climate mitigation policies.

She comes from a renowned background, yet she is focused on paving her own path. Her grandfather, Dr. D. Y. Patil, a former Governor of West Bengal, Tripura and Bihar, established a number of schools and universities, and her parents, Dr. Vijay D. Patil and Mrs. Shivani Vijay Patil, stand by her endeavours. She has chosen to use that platform to spread awareness about protecting the environment

Her next step was to move from individual action to systems and policy. She went on to study at University College London (UCL), and on graduation day she celebrated a BSc in Geography. Even as an 18-year-old preparing for university, she had planned to pursue a major in Environmental Development and Geography.



LEGEND



Dear Dada,

I wanted to say. You were born into an ordinary farming family, and you still went on to build schools, colleges, universities and hospitals across the country. Titles and positions never changed how you treated people, and that is the lesson I carry with me most. You have been part of my work from the beginning. My poetry collection, Mystic, was shaped by my life and by the people around me, especially you, and all of its proceeds went to D-CAL, an environmental conservation organisation. That effort has since grown into the D. Y. Patil Climate Action Lab, which carries your name because it stands for what you stood for. It is also why I started the Charity Soccer League in 2018 to improve medical facilities for children. My motto, "service before self," is something I learned by watching you. I know I can never fill your shoes, but I promise to live by the values you gave me. I will work hard, rise every time life knocks me down, and treat every person with kindness, humility and respect. I will keep serving those who need it most, as you always did. I hope to make you proud in everything I do, and I ask you to keep blessing and guiding me as I carry the baton forward.

Love you always,
Rajlakshmi

The Banker Who Bet on Curiosity

Devi Sahny left Goldman Sachs at 23, moved to Singapore with little more than a conviction, and built two education companies on a radical premise: that self-belief can be taught.



GROWTH WITHOUT COMPROMISE

By the ordinary logic of a Goldman Sachs career, Devi Sahny did something close to heresy. Three years into the firm's mergers-and-acquisitions group in New York the kind of seat thousands compete for she walked away. At 23, with no network and no business plan, she moved to Singapore to start an education company. The founding capital, by her own account, was around eight thousand dollars. The company was Ascend Now. Eight years on, it is a multi-million-dollar education venture, and Sahny has added a second, The Edge, to her name. But the more telling figure sits on no balance sheet. It is the quiet wager underneath both businesses: that the things schools rarely teach curiosity, resilience, the confidence to try are precisely the things that decide a life.. Ascend Now began with a deceptively simple idea. Alongside conventional academic tutoring, Sahny wanted to teach children, some as young as six, to think like founders to spot problems, build things, pitch, fail, and try again. The programme pairs one-on-one coaching with entrepreneurship, and, for teenagers, courses in the skills the classroom tends to skip: networking, negotiation, resilience, managing stress. Mentorship, not marks, is the organising principle. If that sounds counterintuitive for a company that teaches entrepreneurship, that is rather the point. Sahny's argument is that the entrepreneurial cast of mind agency, self-awareness, the appetite to solve real problems is worth cultivating in every child, whether or not they ever start a company.

an era being reshaped by artificial intelligence, she contends, the human capacities that machines cannot copy judgement, empathy, the ability to lead are the ones that will hold their value. That conviction is hard-won rather than theoretical. Her single most important piece of advice to would-be founders is to build, as she puts it, a "positive relationship with failure" the discipline of learning, unlearning and relearning without being flattened by the setbacks along the way.

The origin story is less polished than the accolades suggest. Sahny arrived in Singapore without contacts, without a fixed plan, and with savings that would not stretch far. She had chosen the city precisely because its education system is among the world's most demanding the reasoning of a twenty-three-year-old being that if the idea could work there, it could work anywhere The early years were not glamorous. Long before the company had a reputation, it had a founder willing to do the unglamorous work of proving the model one student at a time. Sahny is candid that the road was non-linear sleepless nights, self-doubt, the constant balancing act of building something from nothing. What carried her through, she has said, was a stubborn refusal to treat a closed door as final; she is a firm believer that you can "convert a no into a yes with the right mindset." As Ascend Now grew, Sahny turned to the harder problem of scale. The result was The Edge, a "life-readiness" platform aimed at students aged roughly 12 to 17 that packages social-emotional learning into videos, gamified lessons and progress tracking







Building students who believe in themselves

- Devi Sahny

on what Ascend Now was always for

It was built, she says, on the back of interviews with more than a thousand students, parents and hiring managers, and mapped against established skills frameworks. The ambition is to lift life-skills education out of the realm of the nice-to-have and embed it in schools, foundations and even ministries of education.

The reach has followed. Between the two companies, Sahny's programmes now touch students across several continents and count partnerships with schools and institutions well into the hundreds a long way from a single founder and a few thousand dollars.



The accolades have kept pace. Sahny has been named to Forbes' 30 Under 30 in Asia, chosen as a Sequoia Spark Fellow in the fund's inaugural cohort, and recognised as a St. Gallen Symposium Leader of Tomorrow. She is a TED and TEDx speaker, and sits on boards and advisory councils spanning Georgetown University where she read philosophy and economics before Goldman Sachs her old school, Antwerp International, and education foundations across Asia. Ask what success looks like, and Sahny tends to reframe the question. She talks less about size or valuation than about whether a child leaves her programmes believing in what they are capable of.

BOJEE



The Boojee Experience

At its core, Boojee is a specialty coffee and community-first café, built around fostering relationships and serving fresh, minimally processed food alongside specialty coffee sourced from various estates. The menu is known for its clean-ingredient sandwiches, wholesome breakfast fare, and coffee that punches well above its weight for a neighbourhood spot — a combination that reviewers have repeatedly praised. On Tripadvisor, Boojee's original Bandra West outlet holds a 4.3 out of 5 rating and ranks among the top coffee and tea spots in Mumbai, with guests highlighting its cozy, quaint black-and-white decor, perfect for relaxed conversations, meetings, or simply unwinding with a good cup of coffee. The café also nurtures its community beyond the counter, hosting events like morning workouts and healthy breakfasts in collaboration with its sister venture, Morii Cafe. Boojee's growth has been steady rather than explosive a deliberate, neighbourhood-by-neighbourhood expansion that has kept its cult status intact. After Bandra, the brand expanded to Worli and Fort, winning over Bandra's brunch loyalists, Fort's coffee devotees and Worli's grab-and-go crowd. In 2026, Boojee announced its most ambitious move yet: an outlet at One BKC, marking its fifth outlet in Mumbai and a first foray into the city's busiest business district.

Boojee was founded by Rajdeep Singh Kukreja, a chef and barista by training, who launched the café in 2019 in a tiny 100-square-foot space in Bandra. The original 15-seater outlet didn't even have a washroom, but that didn't stop the brand from finding its place in Mumbai's food scene. According to reports, Kukreja saw an opportunity in the market for healthy food that was affordable and, importantly, tasted good, and he put nearly ₹10 lakh of his own savings into the venture to open the compact sandwich joint

A key early decision shaped the brand's trajectory: Kukreja opted for a café model instead of a traditional restaurant, which let Boojee stay open from 7 AM to 11 PM and make the most of its operating hours. That long runway, paired with consistently good food, turned casual visitors into regulars — and eventually into a celebrity-favourite spot, without the café ever losing its neighbourhood feel. Beyond Boojee, Kukreja has gone on to co-found other Mumbai food ventures, including Morii Cafe and Eatslow, cementing his reputation as one of the city's more prolific young restaurateurs.

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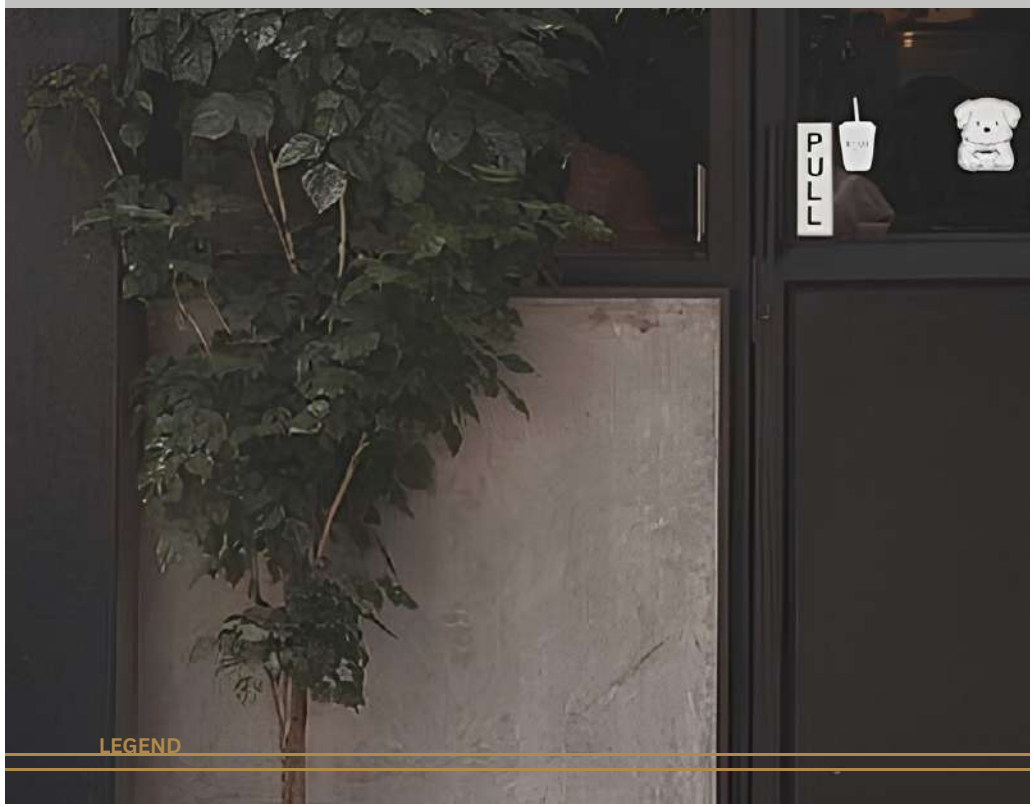


LEGEND

Mumbai's Wider Café Boom

What's striking about Boojee is how it's grown into what one longtime regular described as a "status symbol" spot in Bandra, frequented by "the crème de la crème of Mumbai," while still holding onto the neighbourhood warmth that made it popular in the first place. It's this dual identity — equal parts celebrity haunt and dependable local hangout — that has let Boojee expand steadily without losing its original character, even as its weekly order volumes from nearby offices and its loyal walk-in crowd have kept every outlet consistently busy.

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What's on the Table

Boojee's story is a reminder that in Mumbai's fiercely competitive café scene, scale isn't the only measure of success. A founder's clear vision, a consistent product, and genuine community-building can turn a washroom-less 100-square-foot outlet into a five-location, celebrity-approved institution — all without a single external investor. Boojee's rise has been entirely bootstrapped. Company records show Boojee is an unfunded company based in Mumbai, founded in 2019 by Rajdeep Singh, operating as a restaurant serving multiple dishes, and ranked 18th among 213 active competitors in its category, with annual revenue in the ₹10–50 crore range as of March 2025. The formal entity, Boojee Cafe Private Limited, was incorporated in September 2023, with its current board comprising Rajdeep Singh and Devender Gurubuxsingh Sethi



RISE WITH
PILATES



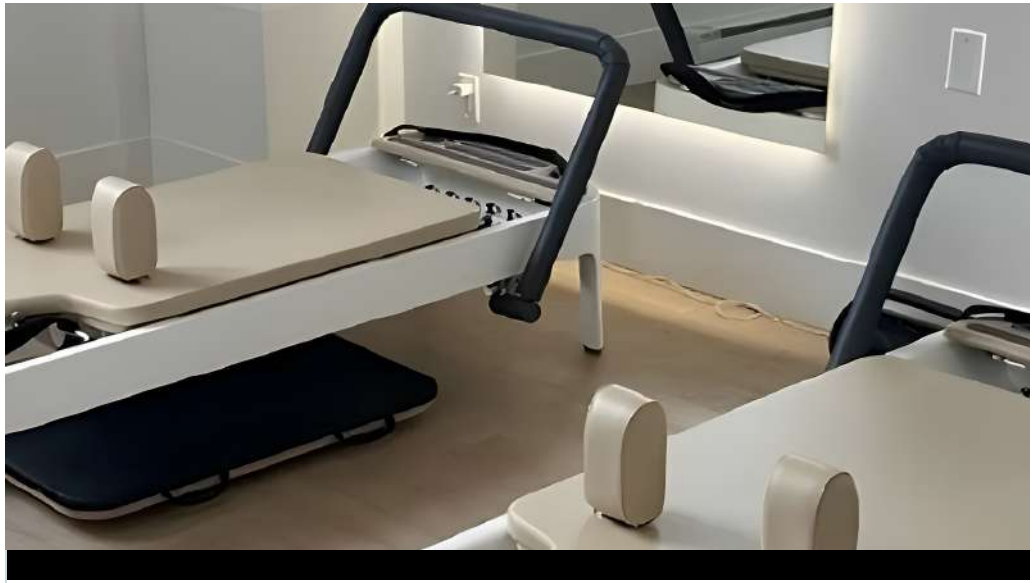
Mindful Movement, Real Results Riding India's Wellness Wave

Inside Mumbai's Newest Wellness Hub: Pilates Academy X Sara Tendulkar Mumbai's fitness scene just got a new address. Nestled in Andheri, Pilates Academy X Sara Tendulkar has opened its doors as the fourth Indian branch of a celebrated Dubai-based Pilates franchise and it's already generating buzz, thanks to its founder: nutritionist-turned-entrepreneur Sara Tendulkar. Unlike conventional gyms built around intensity, this space is designed around intention. The studio's offerings focus on core strength, flexibility, posture, and controlled breathing the foundational principles of Pilates as developed by Joseph Pilates nearly a century ago. What sets this space apart is its blend of movement science with genuine community spirit, echoing the founder's own belief that wellness is as much emotional as it is physical. The timing lines up with a larger shift in India's fitness culture. As urban India moves away from high-impact workouts toward more sustainable, low-impact fitness formats, Pilates has emerged as the format of choice for those seeking long-term results without burnout. Industry estimates value India's Pilates and yoga studio market at over USD 16 billion, with strong growth projected in the years ahead placing boutique studios like this one at the center of a rapidly expanding wellness economy. For its founder, the studio isn't a side project — it's the culmination of years spent balancing academic training in nutrition with a personal devotion to mindful movement. That authenticity is part of what's drawing early attention: this isn't a celebrity name slapped onto a franchise, but a space shaped by real, lived commitment to the practice.

As the studio settles into Mumbai's competitive fitness landscape, its early reception suggests strong local demand for premium, boutique wellness spaces — one rooted less iMumbai's fitness scene just got a new address. Nestled in Andheri, Pilates Academy X Sara Tendulkar has opened its doors as the fourth Indian branch of a celebrated Dubai-based Pilates franchise — and it's already generating buzz, thanks to its founder: nutritionist-turned-entrepreneur Sara Tendulkar.n trends and more in transformation.







WHERE WELLNESS BEGINS

Sara Tendulkar, daughter of cricket legend Sachin Tendulkar, has officially entered the wellness and fitness industry with the launch of her own Pilates studio in Andheri, Mumbai. The venture Pilates Academy X Sara Tendulkar marks the fourth Indian outpost of a well-known Dubai-based Pilates franchise, and signals Sara's shift from social media personality to full-fledged entrepreneur. A Master's graduate in Clinical and Public Health Nutrition from University College London, Sara has long combined her academic background with a personal love for fitness. Her studio brings both together, designed as a space that blends mindful movement, functional strength training, and holistic wellness rather than functioning as just another workout studio. Sara described the space on Instagram as more than just a studio, calling it a community built with care and passion.

Sara's entry into the Pilates space is well-timed. India's Pilates and yoga studio market was valued at roughly USD 16.3 billion in 2024 and is projected to more than double by 2033, driven by rising urban demand for low-impact, high-return fitness formats. As a celebrity-backed boutique offering, her studio is positioned to tap directly into this growth — appealing to an audience that already follows her fitness journey across social media, where she commands a following of over 8 million.. The sentiment reflects her broader philosophy: that fitness should nurture both physical and emotional wellbeing, not just aesthetics. The launch was an intimate celebration attended by her parents, Sachin and Anjali Tendulkar, along with Arjun Tendulkar's fiancée, Saaniya Chandhok, who took part in the customary opening rituals. Sachin shared his pride on social media, noting that nutrition and movement have always mattered deeply in their family, and that watching Sara carry that forward in her own way felt remarkable. Arjun himself couldn't attend, having recently gotten engaged.

SALT
FOR A SMILE



Salt and Oral Care: An Old Remedy That Still Earns Its Place

For generations, families across India and the world have reached for a pinch of salt when the mouth feels sore. Dentists still recommend it today, though it works best when you know what it can and cannot do. Salt is a natural, mild antiseptic. Dissolved in warm water, it creates a slightly hypertonic environment that discourages bacterial growth and draws fluid out of swollen tissue. A saltwater rinse is a soothing supplement, not a substitute. It does not deliver fluoride, so it cannot strengthen enamel or replace toothpaste. It also cannot remove plaque or treat cavities and gum disease. If pain, swelling or bleeding lasts more than a few days, see a dentist.Brush twice a day with fluoride toothpaste, floss daily, and visit your dentist regularly. Keep the saltwater rinse as a simple, affordable helper for those days when your gums need a little extra care. Long before mouthwash aisles and whitening strips, people relied on what was already in the kitchen. In Indian households, a pinch of namak in warm water has been the go-to answer for a sore throat, a sore tooth or an angry gum for generations. Modern dentistry has not thrown the remedy out. It has simply put it in its proper place. Salt is a mild natural antiseptic. When dissolved in warm water, it creates an environment where bacteria find it harder to thrive.

t also draws excess fluid out of swollen tissue, which is why a saltwater rinse often brings relief within minutes. Salt is a helper, not a hero It contains no fluoride, so it cannot strengthen enamel or replace toothpaste. It cannot dissolve plaque, reverse a cavity or cure gum disease. If a toothache, swelling or bleeding lasts beyond two or three days, the answer is a dentist's appointment, not a stronger rinse. A saltwater rinse is a soothing supplement, not a substitute. It does not deliver fluoride, so it cannot strengthen enamel or replace toothpaste. It also cannot remove plaque or treat cavities and gum disease. If pain, swelling or bleeding lasts more than a few days, see a dentist. Salt is a helper, not a hero. It contains no fluoride, so it cannot strengthen enamel or replace toothpaste. It cannot dissolve plaque, reverse a cavity or cure gum disease. If a toothache, swelling or bleeding lasts beyond two or three days, the answer is a dentist's appointment, not a stronger rinse.



salt.

A Pinch of Tradition: The Quiet Science of Salt in Oral Care

Ask anyone who grew up in an Indian household what to do about a sore throat or an aching gum, and the answer often arrives before the question is finished: namak wale paani se gargle karo. No prescription, no product, just salt and warm water. t is easy to dismiss such advice as folklore. But this is one of those rare traditions that modern dental practice has largely endorsed, provided it is understood for what it is. Salt is a mild natural antiseptic. Dissolved in warm water, it makes the mouth a less friendly place for bacteria and draws excess fluid out of swollen tissue. The result is less puffiness, less irritation and a cleaner environment for small wounds to heal The method is as simple as the ingredients. Stir half a teaspoon of salt into a cup of warm water, about 240 ml. Take a mouthful, swish gently for half a minute so the water reaches the gum line and the gaps between teeth, then spit. Repeat two to three times a day.

The water should be comfortably warm, never hot, and the rinse should never be swallowed. The most important part of any salt story is its limits. Salt contains no fluoride, so it cannot protect enamel or replace toothpaste. It does not remove plaque, and it cannot treat cavities or gum disease. Persistent pain, swelling or bleeding beyond two or three days means it is time to see a dentist, not to reach for more salt. The foundations of oral health have not changed: brush twice a day with fluoride toothpaste, clean between the teeth daily, go easy on sugar, and see your dentist regularly. Within that routine, the salt rinse earns a modest but genuine place as a soothing, affordable habit for the days when your mouth needs a little extra care.

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the steady hand

From a Pune childhood to a McKinsey desk to a ₹934 core grooming house preparing for the public markets, Shantanu Deshpande built Bombay Shaving Company on a simple wager: that the Indian morning ritual deserved better.



There is a quiet irony at the heart of Bombay Shaving Company. The brand carries the name of India's most restless city, yet its offices sit in Gurugram. For its founder, the name was never an address. It was a mood: the barber's chair on a Bombay street corner, the hot towel, the steady blade, an old-world confidence in the morning ritual that modern India had somehow misplaced.

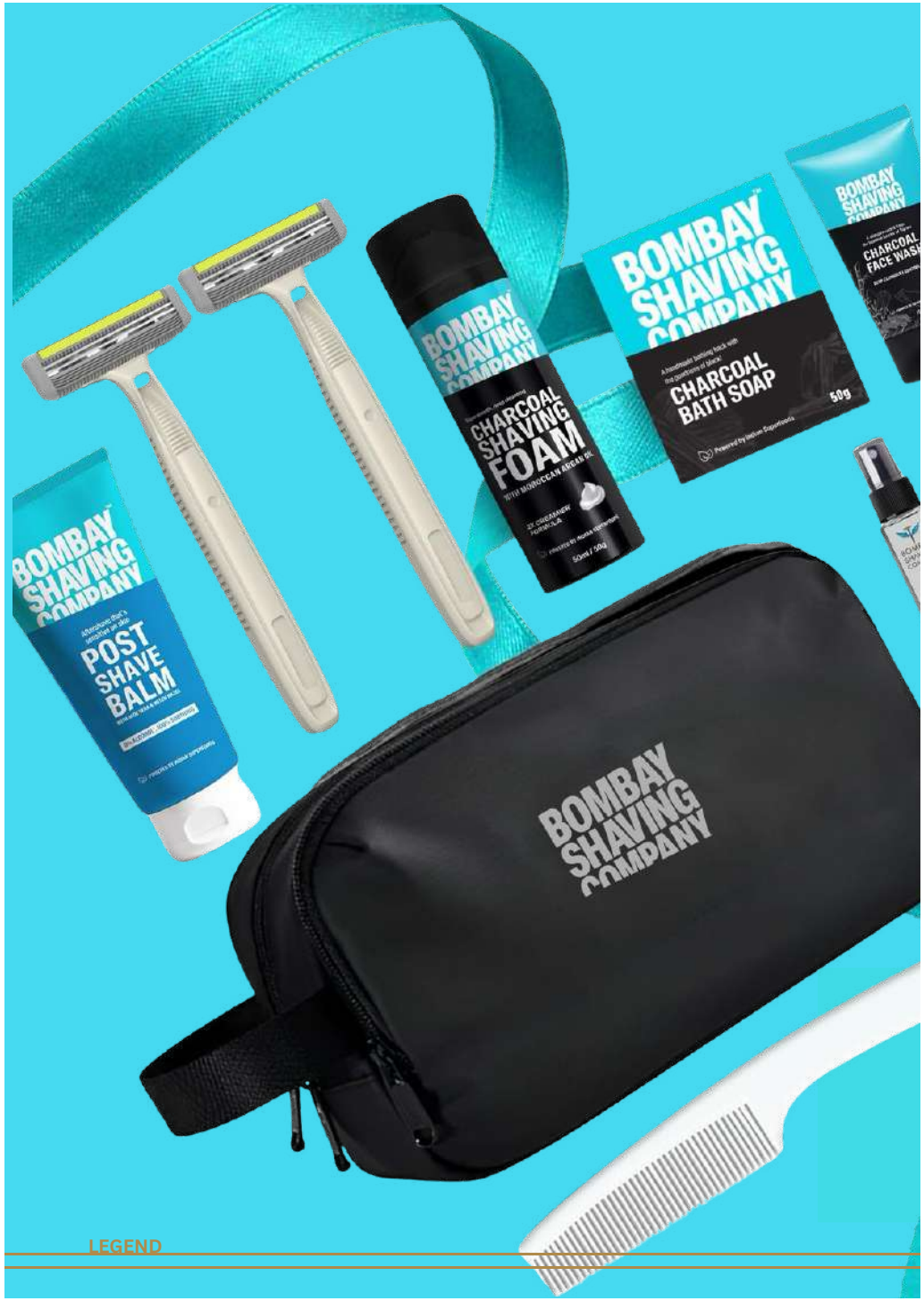
Shantanu Deshpande grew up in Pune, in a household where building things was a family language. His father, Kiran Deshpande, led Tech Mahindra through its formative years and later co-founded Mojo Networks. The son took the engineer's route first, studying computer science at VNIT Nagpur, then an MBA at IIM Lucknow, followed by four ears at McKinsey & Company advising clients across consumer goods, retail and mining.

Consulting gave him a view of how categories harden. Shaving in India was a textbook case: a handful of multinationals, a product sold as pure utility, and a consumer who had never been asked what he actually wanted. Deshpande's wager was that the ritual deserved design, and that the internet could reach the man at the sink more directly than any distributor. He left the firm and started with a single product, a razor sold online to a generation that bought everything else that way.

The early years were a study in patience. Direct-to-consumer brands in India were young, capital was cautious, and the incumbents were formidable. What set Bombay Shaving Company apart was not only its packaging, though that was striking, but its willingness to learn in public. It moved from razors into trimmers, from beard care into skincare and fragrance. Perhaps the most telling endorsement came from within the industry itself: Reckitt and Colgate-Palmolive, two of the world's great consumer houses, came on board as strategic investors.

Then came the turn that redefined the company. Deshpande noticed that a large share of his razor buyers were women, served poorly by products designed as afterthoughts. The result was Bombae, a hair-removal brand for women that has since moved into hair styling. Alongside it sits 100Days.co, a marketing venture born of the lessons learned building the parent brand. The numbers now speak with some authority. In the year ended March 2026, the company's operating revenue rose 139 per cent to ₹634.7 crore, from ₹265.6 crore a year earlier. Losses narrowed by 97 per cent to ₹9 crore, and the business reported a positive adjusted EBITDA for the first time. The target for the current year is ₹1,000 crore.




BOMBAY SHAVING COMPANY
CHARCOAL SHAVING FOAM
CHARCOAL BATH SOAP
50g
POST SHAVE BALM
CHARCOAL FACE WASH

LEGEND


BOMBAY SHAVING COMPANY



The Long View!

He came home from Atlanta in 2003 to a mid-sized Mumbai builder. Two decades later, Abhishek Lodha runs one of India's largest real estate companies, and has handed a fifth of it to the nation. Walk through central Mumbai today and it is easy to forget that the towers rising there stand on what were once the city's textile mills. The Apollo Mill compound, bought in 2005, was among the first of Mumbai's old textile sites to be reimagined as a place to live. It was also one of the first large bets of a young man who had only recently come home.Abhishek Lodha took the long way home. He studied in the United States at the Georgia Institute of Technology, where he graduated with the President's Award for the highest grade-point average in his class, and joined McKinsey & Company in Atlanta, advising Fortune 500 clients on strategy. The Lodha Group, founded by his father Mangal Prabhat Lodha in 1980, was then a respected but middle-rung Mumbai developer.

He joined the business in 2003 and became Managing Director in 2010. The consultant's habits came with him: a preference for data over instinct, for process over personality, and for scale. Within a decade, annual sales had risen from about ₹50 crore to more than ₹7,500 crore, and the company had become the country's largest residential developer by sales. The clearest expression of that long view is Palava, the township on Mumbai's eastern fringe that Lodha has shaped over many years into a city of its own.

Scale alone was never quite the point. Lodha brought a design sensibility unusual for Indian housing at the time, collaborating with names such as Armani/Casa and Philippe Starck and treating the lobby, the landscape and the view as seriously as the floor plan. The towers that rose on the old mill land announced a new kind of Mumbai address, one that borrowed openly from global luxury while remaining unmistakably of the city. The growth was not without strain. Like much of Indian real estate in the late 2010s, Lodha carried heavy debt into a slowing market, and the years before its 2021 stock-market listing tested both the balance sheet and the man at its centre. What followed is perhaps his most instructive chapter. The company, then called Macrotech Developers, listed in April 2021 and set about reducing its borrowings with unusual discipline, shifting toward joint development arrangements that required less upfront capital. The results are visible in the numbers. In the year ended March 2026, pre-sales reached ₹20,530 crore and profit after tax rose 24 per cent to ₹3,431 crore, a margin of about 20 per cent. Net debt stood at ₹5,377 crore, a fraction of what it once was. The company now trades under the name its customers always used: Lodha Developers. Yet Lodha speaks of the company's size with something close to restraint. Its share of primary housing sales across India's six largest cities, he notes, is only about 3.5 per cent by value, which he reads not as a ceiling but as a runway.

LODHA



The Patient Builder



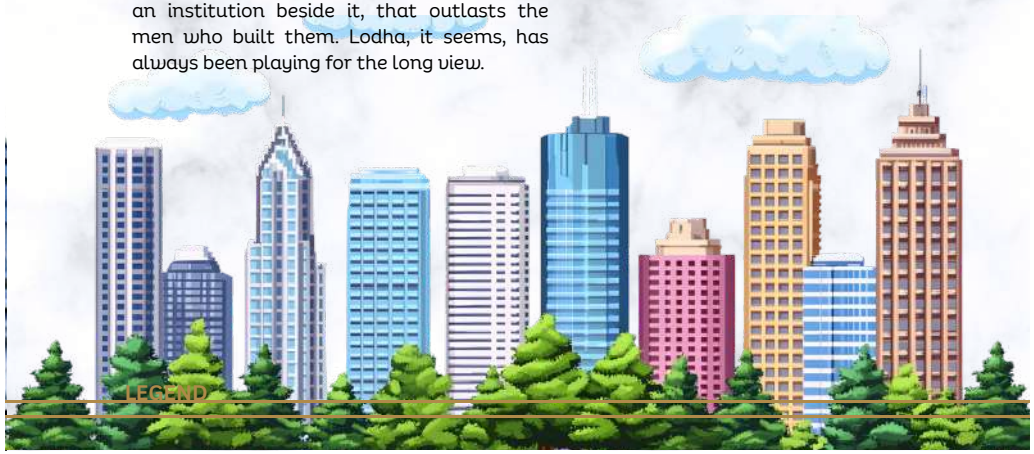
The clearest expression of that long view is Palava, the township on Mumbai's eastern fringe that Lodha has shaped over many years into a city of its own. It now doubles as a live laboratory for the Lodha-RMI Net Zero Urban Accelerator, a partnership with the Rocky Mountain Institute on how Indian cities might decarbonise as they group. In October 2024, Lodha made the decision that may define him most. He transferred roughly a fifth of his family's shareholding in the company, worth around ₹20,000 crore at the time, to the Lodha Philanthropy Foundation. Its work spans women's economic participation, children's education, the environment and Indian culture, through initiatives such as the Lodha Mathematical Sciences Institute and the Lodha Genius Programme. As he put it then, the whole country would become a partner in the company's growth. It was an unusual gesture in Indian business, where family holdings are guarded closely and giving is often quiet. It also tied the foundation's fortunes to the company's performance, so that every good year for Lodha becomes a good year for its causes.

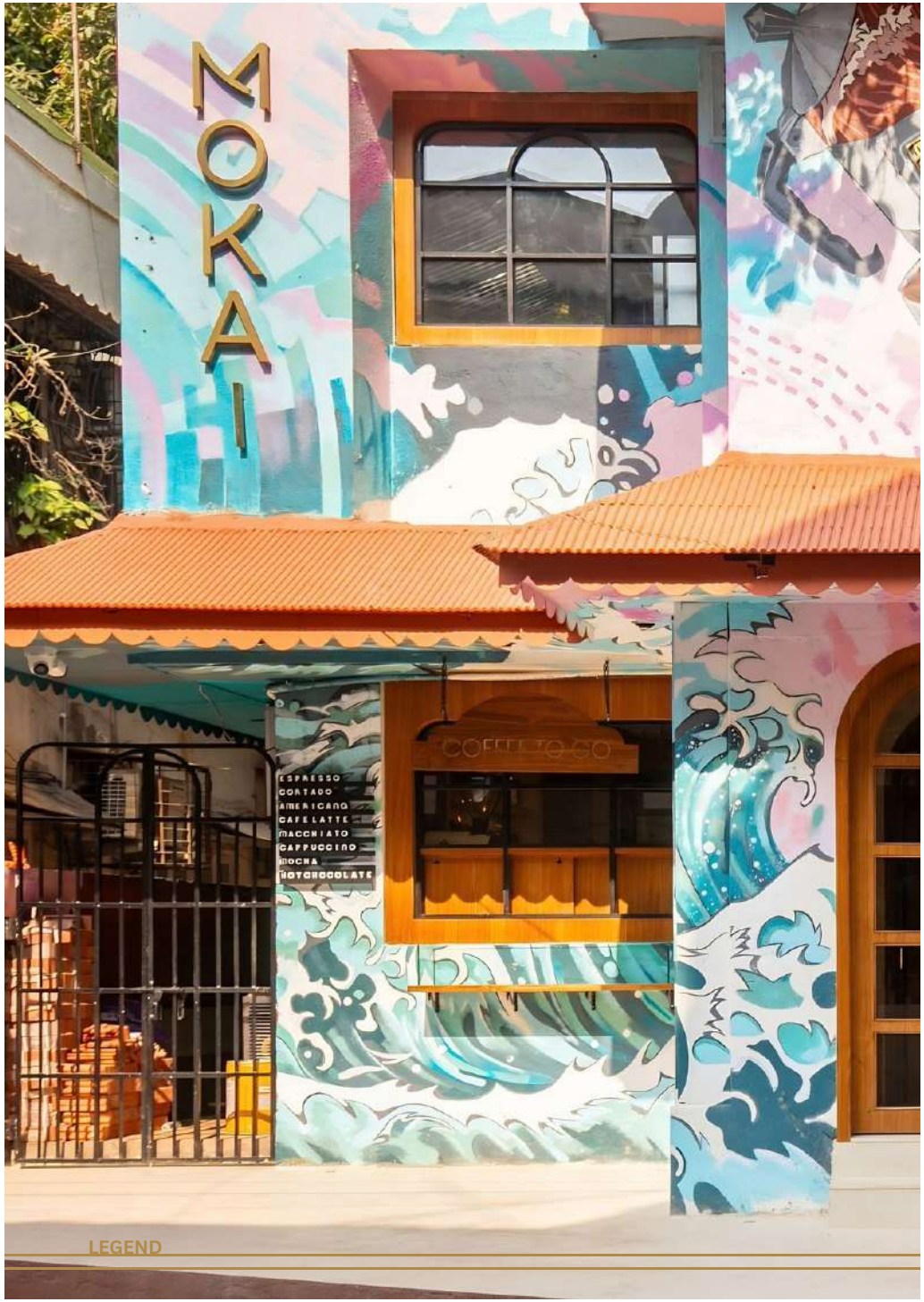
Two decades on from Apollo Mill, the skyline of central Mumbai carries his signature, and the balance sheet carries his discipline. What remains to be written is the larger ambition he has set himself: to build a company, and an institution beside it, that outlasts the men who built them. Lodha, it seems, has always been playing for the long view.

Yet Lodha speaks of the company's size with something close to restraint. Its share of primary housing sales across India's six largest cities, he notes, is only about 3.5 per cent by value, which he reads not as a ceiling but as a runway. Beyond homes, the group has moved into offices, retail, warehousing and data centres, and it has built what it describes as one of India's largest green portfolios.

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Tey grow.





LEGEND



LEGEND

UP THE HILL!!

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Karreena Bulchandani built it out of two things she cares about more than most: coffee and travel. The menu reads like a passport stamped across East and Southeast Asia manual brews, eight kinds of matcha, Japanese-inspired eggs, smoothies in colours that photograph better than they have any right to. But the founder's ambition was never simply to serve good coffee. It was to change what a café in Mumbai was for. When Mokai opened in 2024, she described the gap she wanted to close: the city's cafés were places to order, sip and leave. She wanted somewhere people could "relax, enjoy themselves, and also have a meal along with a cup of coffee." A café, in other words, built for the second kind of morning the one you don't hurry. The setting did much of the talking. An old Bandra bungalow, threaded with Japanese design references, sat in a lane better known for its murals than its menus. It was, by any measure, Instagrammable a word Bulchandani's team never ran from. Where most restaurants treat social media as a noticeboard, Mokai treated it as a stage. The café's account became a small comedy channel: short, self-aware skits, often fronted by Suraksha, the team member who became Mokai's on-screen face, with cameos from Orry, Shanaya Kapoor and Sanya Malhotra. The tone was light, the production unfussy, the recall enormous. It made Mokai something rare in Mumbai's crowded café market a brand people followed before they had ever visited.

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The café's account became a small comedy channel: short, self-aware skits, often fronted by Suraksha, the team member who became Mokai's on-screen fa By late 2025, Bulchandani was being asked to explain it. At Jai Hind College's Constellation festival, she sat on a founders' panel beside the people behind Benne, Bokka and Croffle Guys a cohort that has redrawn what a young Mumbai food brand looks like: product first, and an unusually sharp sense of audience close behind.

ce, with cameos from Orry, Shanaya Kapoor and Sanya Malhotra. The tone was light, the production unfussy, the recall enormous. It made Mokai something rare in Mumbai's crowded café market a brand people followed before they had ever visited. Then, in March 2026, at what looked like the height of it, she closed the doors. Mokai shut its Chapel Road location on 13 March. Six days later, at eight in the morning on 19 March, it reopened at Hill Crest Building on Ambedkar Road, Pali Naka — Mokai 2.0, larger and more considered, a short walk up the hill. Naturally, the new address was announced in a skit.

Moving a beloved café is a risk most operators avoid. A following built on a particular room can stay behind with the room. Moving is how you find out whether people came for the walls or for what happened inside them. Mokai's story is, in the end, a Bandra story. The suburb has always rewarded places that feel like somewhere rather than something. Bulchandani understood early that people do not return for coffee alone. They return for a room, a ritual, a feeling of being in on something. She built all three and then had the nerve to build them again. By late 2025, Bulchandani was being asked to explain it. At Jai Hind College's Constellation festival, she sat on a founders' panel beside the people behind Benne, Bokka and Croffle Guys a cohort that has redrawn what a young Mumbai food brand looks like: product first, and an unusually sharp sense of audience close behind.



LEGEND



Strength, Quietly

Karreena Bulchandani had no hospitality background, a room full of doubters, and an idea she had carried home from Asia. Mokai is what she built with it. Long before there was a café, there was a homesickness of an unusual kind. Karreena Bulchandani grew up between China, Singapore and London, and somewhere in those years she fell for a particular way of drinking coffee: unhurried, considered, in rooms designed to make you stay. Back in Mumbai, she kept looking for that feeling and not finding it. "I missed the café cultures I had fallen in love with in Japan, Singapore, and China," she has said. So she decided to build one. The name tells you what she was after. Mokai joins "moka," the coffee pot, with "ai," the Japanese word for love. When it opened on Chapel Road in Bandra in 2024, it was not meant to copy anything. "I didn't want to replicate an existing format," she said, "but create a space that felt immersive and layered."

She came to it without a traditional hospitality background, and she heard about it. "Some people doubted the idea, the timing, and whether I could run operations in such a tough industry." As a woman founder, she found, you are often taken for "the creative face" and not always taken seriously when the conversation turns to operations or money. Her answer was consistency. The early months were hard, and she learned to "detach emotionally from daily fluctuations and focus on long-term consistency." She also learned to let go. Having tried to run everything herself, she came to see that "giving tasks to others isn't a sign of weakness; it's what lets a brand grow."

The steadiness, she says, came from her mother. "Her discipline and quiet confidence shaped how I approach both life and business. She showed me that strength doesn't always have to be loud." It is a fair description of the founder, too: a café famous for its noise online, run by someone whose instincts lean towards longevity. "I'm more interested in ideas that have longevity rather than trends that come and go."

Strength doesn't always have to be loud.

LEGEND

Daily Objects

Everything You Touched Today

DailyObjects has spent fourteen years designing the things you stop noticing by breakfast. That, it turns out, was the whole idea.

Most brands want to be looked at. DailyObjects wants to be forgotten, gently, about four seconds after you pick it up. Its products are the case around the phone, the sleeve around the laptop, the tray where the keys land at night. You notice them only when they fail. The company's ambition is that you never do. To understand a brand like that, you cannot sit it down for an interview. You have to spend a day with it.





6:52 AM

The case

The alarm is silenced through a phone case. It is the first thing most of us touch each morning, and it is where DailyObjects began. In 2012, during the early, uncertain years of Indian e-commerce, the company sold phone cases and laptop sleeves made by other brands. Two years in, its co-founder and CEO, Pankaj Garg, made the decision that defined everything after: stop reselling, start making.

It began with the case, refined until it was right before anything else was attempted. The thinking was simple and unglamorous. As Garg has put it, a phone case has to survive a drop, but it also has to feel like something you chose, not something you settled for. Today that idea has grown into Stack, a modular case system with more than 980 possible combinations.

8:40 AM

The bag

The commute is where the brand has quietly become something larger. Bags and wallets are now the single biggest part of its business, by its own account more than a third of sales. A laptop bag on a Mumbai local is tested harder than any lab could manage: monsoon water, elbows, a train that does not fully stop. The brand's bet was that Indian buyers would pay for that kind of durability if it came with restraint in design, and roughly half its customers now come back to buy again.



11;15 AM

The desk

By late morning the objects multiply: a charging stand, a cable organiser, a desk mat, a watch band. Node and Loft, the company's wireless chargers, were designed to sit on a desk as objects in their own right rather than as gadgets to hide. This is the brand's most distinctive instinct. It treats tech accessories the way an older generation treated a good fountain pen or a leather diary: as things that say something about the person who owns them.



2:30 PM

The village

The afternoon is a good time for the part of the story that does not fit on a product page. Garg grew up in Mubarikpur, a small village in Rajasthan's Alwar district, far from design schools and far from the urban consumer he would eventually build for. He has spoken of being driven by curiosity across technology, design, music and film rather than by a fixed plan. That distance shows in what the brand refuses to do. DailyObjects does not decorate its products with paisleys or temple motifs to prove where it is from. Garg's view is that Indianness does not live in motifs, and that a confident Indian brand should not have to perform its identity. The result is a company that is unmistakably Indian in its pricing, its customer and its ambition, and almost entirely silent about it on the surface.

LEGEND

LEGEND

6:45 PM

The Store

For most of its life, DailyObjects existed only on screens. That is changing. In July 2025 it opened its first Mumbai store, at Oberoi Sky City Mall in Borivali, the start of a plan for up to 40 brand-owned stores over three years. Its products also sit in a growing network of Apple authorised retailers, a placement that says a great deal about where the brand sees itself.he numbers behind the shelves are moving quickly. Operating revenue reached about ₹111 crore in FY25, up roughly 30 per cent, and the company has publicly aimed to double that in FY26. Like most young Indian consumer brands, it is still working its way to profitability.

11:30 PM

The Tray

At the end of the day, the phone goes down, the watch comes off, the keys land somewhere. If they land in a DailyObjects organiser, the brand has done its job a final time, without being thanked. There is a particular kind of ambition in that. Fourteen years in, the company has built a business on the conviction that ordinary things deserve real design, and that good design does not have to be expensive or exclusive. Garg's own phrase for it is plain: good design, for everyday objects, made for India. Not gatekept. Democratised. The numbers behind the shelves are moving quickly. Operating revenue reached about ₹111 crore in FY25, up roughly 30 per cent, and the company has publicly aimed to double that in FY26. Like most young Indian consumer brands, it is still working its way to profitability. Funding has come from investors including 360 ONE Asset, which led a $10 million Series B in 2024.



LEGEND

The Eye and the Engine

Long before DailyObjects, Pankaj Garg and Saurav Adlakha were simply two people who loved gadgets. Their first venture together, Salesdekho, was a deals website. It did not make them famous, but it taught them how to work together, and it showed them a gap no one was filling: Indians were buying smartphones by the million, and almost nothing worth carrying them in.

So they tried again, smaller and sharper. Lootspot sold gadget accessories online. When Mumbai's Seedfund backed them, they renamed it in 2012 to something that said exactly what they meant: DailyObjects.

The partnership is a familiar one in Indian business, and it works because the roles are clear. Garg, the CEO, is the eye. He grew up in Mubarikpur, a village in Rajasthan's Alwar district, and has been led by curiosity about design, technology, music and film more than by any fixed plan. Adlakha, the COO, is the engine: supply, operations, stores, and making sure a good idea actually reaches the customer.

Their most important decision came two years in, when they stopped selling other brands' products and started making their own. It meant a factory, craftsmen and real risk. Fourteen years on, that same pair runs a brand with stores from Gurugram to Borivali, built on the belief they started with: everyday things deserve good design.



LEGEND



AGAINST THE SIGNAL

Jay Jajal named his label after an offence. Seven years and two runways later, the Borivali boy who built Jaywalking is working out which rules were worth breaking and which ones he should have kept.

Jaywalker" was never meant kindly. In early twentieth-century America, a "jay" was a rube a country hick who didn't understand how the city worked and the word was put to work shaming anyone who crossed the street where the new motor cars said they shouldn't. It was, in other words, an insult designed to keep people on the kerb.Jay Jajal took the insult and stitched it into a label.That he did so from a chawl in Borivali is the first thing worth knowing about him. The second is that he very nearly didn't become a designer at all. Before the clothes, there was the microphone: Jajal wanted to be a rapper, and he speaks of not chasing that dream with something closer to relief than regret. Fashion, it turned out, gave him the stage without the setlist. The family story begins in Mahuva, a small town in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district, where his father grew up. The father's ambition for the son was sensible and specific: business administration, in Singapore. It is an education that shows. Ask most young designers about their strengths and they will talk about cut, or concept, or craft. Jajal heavily tattooed, cheerfully irreverent is more likely to tell you he is a very good marketer, and to mean it as the compliment it is. He is less generous about his own sketches, which he has been known to call ugly. It is a revealing admission.

The drawings were never meant to be the finished thing. They were raw material his own artwork, pressed into service on cloth because he liked it too much to leave it on paper.aywalking arrived in 2019, and it arrived loudly. At Lakmé Fashion Week that August, in a showcase built around India's new streetwear, the label sent out black and neon, cyber styling crossed with 1990s nostalgia, logos everywhere and lightning bolts cracking across the runway. It was not subtle. It was not trying to be.

What it was, in hindsight, was early. Indian hype culture the drops, the queues, the resale was only beginning to find its feet, and Jaywalking became one of the names that taught it to walk. Jajal is careful not to overclaim. He has said that Indian streetwear always existed; he simply came along and redecorated it. Underneath the noise, the label was learning to sew. A masterjee taught him pattern cutting, and how fabric could be moulded rather than merely printed on, and the line widened: menswear, womenswear, gender-fluid ready-to-wear, custom pieces, all held together by a language of deconstruction and experiment. Jajal describes Jaywalking as dangerous a brand for people willing to cross the line. It reads like marketing. It is also a fairly accurate description of the clothes.

When the artist takes a back seat, a collection starts to feel like arithmetic.









Jaywalking arrived in 2019, and it arrived loudly. At Lakmé Fashion Week that August, in a showcase built around India's new streetwear, the label sent out black and neon, cyber styling crossed with 1990s nostalgia, logos everywhere and lightning bolts cracking across the runway. It was not subtle. It was not trying to be.

What it was, in hindsight, was early. Indian hype culture — the drops, the queues, the resale — was only beginning to find its feet, and Jaywalking became one of the names that taught it to walk. Jajal is careful not to overclaim. He has said that Indian streetwear always existed; he simply came along and redecorated it.

Underneath the noise, the label was learning to sew. A masterjee taught him pattern cutting, and how fabric could be moulded rather than merely printed on, and the line widened: menswear, womenswear, gender-fluid ready-to-wear, custom pieces, all held together by a language of deconstruction and experiment. Jajal describes Jaywalking as dangerous — a brand for people willing to cross the line. It reads like marketing. It is also a fairly accurate description of the clothes. Mumbai eventually gave the label a home with a sense of humour. Jaywalking's flagship sits in Kala Ghoda's Rhythm House, the address where generations of the city once went to buy their music — a fitting landing place for a would-be rapper. Inside, it is built less like a shop than an underground gallery, the clothes presented as though they might belong on the wall.

In March 2024, after five years away from the runway, Jajal returned to Lakmé Fashion Week as part of the GQ x FDCI Men's Edit. He was thirty. The comeback arrived with a candour most founders keep to themselves. In growing the business, he has admitted, something personal slipped — the closeness to the clothes, to the masterjee, to the hand. When the artist takes a back seat, he says, a collection starts to feel like arithmetic.

His answer is not to shout louder. It is to go back to basics — literally. Jajal now talks about having fun with the pieces everyone already owns, about a "test fit" garment he is excited by, and about the fact that India, for all its noise, is not yet ready for clothes at the far edge of experiment. It is the voice of someone who has crossed against the light often enough to know exactly how fast the traffic is moving There is a reason pedestrians in this city cross where they like. The zebra is too far away, the signal is too slow, and the other side is right there. Jaywalking was built on that instinct. What makes Jay Jajal interesting now is that he has started looking both ways.

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LEGEND

THE TRANSLATOR

Between the hospital ward and the boardroom lies a language problem. Harshvi Shah has built an early career on solving it and on teaching others the unwritten grammar of ambition.



Most conversations about healthcare innovation begin with the breakthrough: the new drug, the new device, the algorithm that reads a scan. Fewer begin where Harshvi Shah's work does with the question of whether anyone can actually measure what the breakthrough changes, and whether the people paying for it understand what they are buying. It is an unglamorous question. It is also, increasingly, the one that decides which innovations reach patients and which remain in the laboratory. Harshvi is a research analyst in the healthcare practice of Ipsos, the global market research firm. The work sits at an unusual junction. Pharmaceutical companies, device makers and health systems come to firms like Ipsos to understand what clinicians think, how patients behave, and where an unmet need is real rather than assumed. The analyst's task is to turn interviews, surveys and datasets into something a decision-maker can act on. It is translation, in the strictest sense.

Her preparation for that role was deliberately two-sided. She completed her undergraduate degree at Imperial College London, one of Europe's leading institutions for science and medicine, and followed it with a master's in health informatics at Cornell University a discipline concerned with how health data is gathered, structured and put to use. She held offers from more. The clearest marker of her academic seriousness came while she was still an undergraduate.

Harshvi is a co-author of a systematic review published in JMIR Aging in August 2024, produced with researchers in Imperial's Department of Brain Sciences. The paper examined markerless motion capture the use of ordinary cameras and depth sensors, rather than laboratory body-markers, to track how a person moves as a way of measuring functional decline in people with dementia, mild cognitive impairment and Parkinson's disease. The appeal of the technology is easy to grasp. If a camera in a living room could reliably register a slowing gait or a hesitation in rising from a chair, clinicians would gain a continuous, unobtrusive window into a patient's condition, rather than the snapshot of a fifteen-minute appointment. The review's conclusion was characteristically sober. From close to 1,600 search results, the team found only six studies that had rigorously tested such systems against gold-standard motion capture. The promise, in other words, still outran the proof. That finding says something about the temperament the field demands. Healthcare does not reward enthusiasm on its own. It rewards the patience to ask whether something works, for whom, and how anyone would know.

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Then came the job search. Within three months, she secured two full-time offers and two internships. Rather than treat that as a private result, she turned it into a public resource.

Through Topmate, the platform for paid one-to-one sessions, Shah now mentors students and early career professionals on graduate applications, CVs and job-search strategy. She has completed more than fifty sessions and holds a perfect rating across twenty-two reviews. She has also made her own application documents the CV built across Imperial and Cornell, and the cover letter behind her consulting offers available to others. Alongside it runs an Instagram account, Hired Over Coffee, aimed at the same audience.

There is a quiet generosity in that choice. The rules of elite admissions and graduate hiring are rarely written down; they pass between people who already know them. Shah's mentoring is, at heart, the same act as her day job: taking something opaque and making it legible to the person who needs it.The reviews her mentees leave tend to praise the same things clarity, practicality, and a willingness to answer questions in depth. They are the qualities of a good analyst, applied to a different kind of client.

Shah is at the beginning of her career, and it would be premature to describe it in terms of arrival. What is already visible is a pattern: a scientist's training, an analyst's discipline, and an instinct to share what she has learned rather than keep it. In a field where the distance between laboratory and patient is measured in years and billions, people who can work in that gap and explain it will matter more, not less.

> "People who can work in that gap and explain it will matter more, not less."

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